

Money and shopping

Speaking Part 1

Imagine that you are preparing a project with your friend. You have found some interesting material for the presentation and you want to read this text to your friend. You have 1.5 minutes to read the text silently, then be ready to read it out aloud. You will not have more than 1.5 minutes to read it.

Pocket money is an important part of a teenager's financial education, however, a recent survey shows that many teenagers do not use their pocket money wisely. 60% of teenagers spend their pocket money on non-essential items such as clothes, gadgets and entertainment, while only 20% save it and only 10% spend it on necessary items such as food and bills. To encourage teenagers to use their pocket money wisely, providing them with financial education and guidance on budgeting and money management and setting clear rules and expectations on how they should use their pocket money, such as setting a percentage that must be saved or spent on necessary items, can be effective solutions. It's important to educate and guide teenagers on how to manage their money wisely and make responsible spending decisions, which can set them on the path to financial success.

Speaking Part 2. Task 1

Study the advertisement.

A new shopping centre is now looking for staff



You are planning to work in this shopping mall in Zetland and you'd like to get more information about the centre. In 1.5 minutes you are to ask four direct questions to find out about the following:

1. location
2. minimum age for employment
3. salary
4. uniform

You have 20 seconds to ask each question.

Look at the following questions asked by a student. What is wrong with them?

Student's answers:

1. Where is the location of your shopping mall?
2. What minimum age do you have for employment?
3. What kind of salary you provide?
4. Are uniform necessary to wear?

Speaking Part 2. Task 2

Study the advertisement.

"Mimimo" shopping centre



You are planning to visit a modern shopping centre and you'd like to get more information about the centre. In 1.5 minutes you are to ask four direct questions to find out about the following:

1. number of floors;
2. opening hours;
3. parking at the shopping centre;
4. if there is a food court.

You have 20 seconds to ask each question.

Speaking Part 3. Task 1

You are going to give an interview. You have to answer five questions.

Give full answers to the questions (2-3 sentences).

Remember that you have 40 seconds to answer each question.

Tapescript for task 3.

Interviewer: Hello everybody! It's *Teenagers Round the World* Channel. Our guest today is a teenager from Russia and we are going to discuss money and shopping. We'd like to know our guest's point of view on this issue. Please answer five questions. So, let's get started.

Interviewer: How much money do you spend a month? What do you buy?

Student: _____

Interviewer: Are you good at saving money? Why do you think so?

Student: _____

Interviewer: Have you ever bought anything online? Are there any problems when people shop online in Russia?

Student: _____

Interviewer: What is the most fashionable thing to buy nowadays? Do teenagers buy fashionable things?

Student: _____

Interviewer: Do you feel that you have enough money to do the things you want? Why or why not?

Student: _____

Interviewer: Thank you very much for your interview.

Suggested answers for Speaking Part 2. Task 1:

1. This is a wrong wording of a question. You can ask: What is the location of your shopping mall? What's the address of your shopping mall?
2. A minimum age is not something that companies possess. Appropriate questions would be: What's the minimum age for employment in your shopping mall?
3. You need an auxiliary verb to ask the question: What salary do you provide?
4. The word 'uniform' is either singular or uncountable. If you make a grammar mistake, you do not get a point for a question. Is a uniform necessary to wear?

Suggested answers for Speaking Part 2. Task 2:

1. How many floors are there in your shopping centre?
2. What are the opening hours of your shopping centre?
3. Can I park my car at the shopping centre? Is parking available at your shopping centre?
4. Is there a food court? Do you have a food court?

Suggested answers for Speaking Part 3. Task 1:

1. I usually spend a few thousand roubles /'ru:blz/ a month. I spend money in cafes with my friends. Sometimes I buy clothes.
2. I'm not good at saving money. I usually spend all the money once I'm given it.
3. I buy something online quite often. I don't think there are any problems with shopping online in Russia. It's very convenient and we have a good delivery service.
4. The most fashionable thing to buy is the latest edition of a phone. I think teenagers try to follow fashion trends. They buy trendy things to show off.
5. I guess I have enough money to do the things I want. If I need some money to buy some things I really need, I can ask my parents and they never refuse.

Speaking Part 3. Task 2

You are going to give an interview. You have to answer five questions.

Give full answers to the questions (2-3 sentences).

Remember that you have 40 seconds to answer each question.

Tapescript for task 3.

Interviewer: Hello everybody! It's *Teenagers Round the World* Channel. Our guest today is a teenager from Russia and we are going to discuss shopping online and offline. We'd like to know our guest's point of view on this issue. Please answer five questions. So, let's get started.

Interviewer: How often do you buy clothes? Who chooses clothes for you?

Student: _____

Interviewer: What would you never buy online? Why is that so?

Student: _____

Interviewer: How do you pay for things you buy?

Student: _____

Interviewer: How important are designer labels for you? Do you think it's necessary to keep in fashion?

Student: _____

Interviewer: Have you ever had to complain about something you've bought? What happened?

Student: _____

Interviewer: Thank you very much for your interview.

Speaking Part 4. Task 1

In the last speaking task, you give your friend a call, telling him or her about some pictures that you have found. This means you need an appropriate greeting (Hi Masha\Hi Petya...) and a corresponding concluding sentence (Call me back). If you do not have either of these items, you lose two points. If you do not have both of them, you lose three points for Organisation.

Look at the following sample answer for the task below. What will you add?

Imagine that you and your friend are doing a school project "Different Ways to Pay for Things". You have found some photos to illustrate it but for technical reasons you cannot send them now. Leave a voice message to your friend explaining your choice of the photos and sharing some ideas about the project. In 2.5 minutes be ready to:

- explain the choice of the illustrations for the project by briefly describing them and noting the differences;
- mention the advantages (1-2) of the two payment options;
- mention the disadvantages (1-2) of the two payment options;
- express your opinion on the subject of the project – which way of paying presented in the pictures you prefer and why.

You will speak for not more than 3 minutes (12-15 sentences). You have to talk continuously.



Student's answer:

I have found two pictures for our project. I want to tell you about them.

In the first picture I can see some money. Someone is holding it. In the second picture, there is someone holding a credit card and trying to pay with it.

There are some advantages of the payment options. Cash is accepted everywhere, while you can have a lot of money on your credit card and you don't need to withdraw it to pay for expensive goods.

There are also some disadvantages of using these methods. There could be bacteria on cash because a lot of people touch it.

Personally, I like paying with my credit card.

That's all about the pictures. Call me back.

Suggested answers for Speaking Part 3. Task 2

1. I usually buy new clothes every other month. Fortunately, my mom doesn't make me buy the things she likes, so I choose clothes myself.
2. I would never buy shoes online without trying them on. I think it's very important to see whether a piece of clothes suits you and fits you. It's also more difficult to give the thing back if you change your mind.
3. If I pay for things online, I usually use my credit card or Yandex money. If I need to buy something offline or use a vending machine, I may use some cash.
4. Designer labels are not really important for me. I believe people should wear clothes they look good in. For this reason, fashion is not important, so it's not necessary to keep in it.
5. Yes. Once I bought a tablet and then found out that they gave me the wrong model. I had to write a letter of complaint. Luckily, they took it back and gave me a refund.

Answers for Speaking Part 4. Task 1

A greeting (Hi Masha)

The name of the project "Different Ways to Pay for Things".

Explanation, why the photos are suitable (Both of the pictures illustrate different payment methods).

What the difference is (the difference between the pictures is obvious: one photo depicts the usage of cash as a payment option, while there is an electronic device involved in the second picture).

Another disadvantage for paying with a credit card (Sometimes there's no electricity in some areas because of cut-offs. It's not possible to pay for purchases with your credit card in this case).

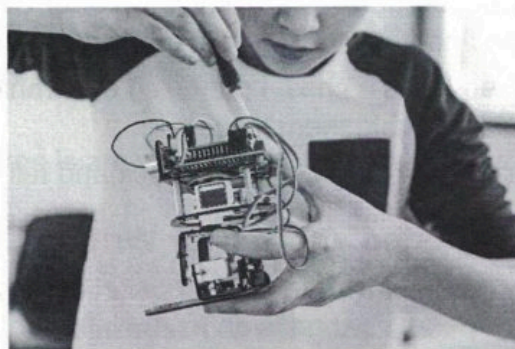
There is no explanation why you prefer this method of payment (because my parents always send me some pocket money to my card. I just never have any cash).

Speaking Part 4. Task 2

Imagine that you and your friend are doing a school project "Toys for kids". You have found some photos to illustrate it but for technical reasons you cannot send them now. Leave a voice message to your friend explaining your choice of the photos and sharing some ideas about the project. In 2.5 minutes be ready to:

- explain the choice of the illustrations for the project by briefly describing them and noting the differences;
- mention the advantages (1-2) of the two kinds of toys for kids;
- mention the disadvantages (1-2) of the two kinds of toys for kids;
- express your opinion on the subject of the project – which type of toys presented in the pictures you preferred as a kid and why;

You will speak for not more than 3 minutes (12-15 sentences). You have to talk continuously.



Writing an email. Task 1

You got an email from your friend. He told you about his problems with pocket money and asked you 3 questions. Answer them:

1. How often do your parents give you pocket money?
2. What can you spend your money on?
3. Can you manage your money? Do you put money aside?

Your friend also told you that he'd spent the whole weekend shopping. Ask him about the shopping centre near his house. Write down 3 questions.

Suggested answers for Speaking Part 4. Task 2:

Hi, Irina, I'm calling to tell you about the pictures I've found for our project "Toys for kids".

I think the pictures are perfectly suitable for our project because they both show little children playing with toys. In the first picture, there's a little girl sitting on the floor and playing with a fluffy toy. Perhaps, it's a rabbit. She's wearing quite warm clothes, so maybe she got the toy as a New Year present. In the second picture, there's a boy making a robot. There are lots of wires and he's using a screwdriver to attach necessary elements. The difference between the pictures is in the types of toys: an ordinary toy in the first picture and an electronic toy in the second picture.

There are certain advantages of the two kinds of toys for kids. If children play with fluffy toys, it develops their imagination and creativity as they have to make up a story and they can role play with such toys. As for electronic ones, they develop attentiveness especially if you have to assemble them. Such toys also seem to be a lot of fun.

Unfortunately, there are some downsides of playing with the two kinds of toys. Fluffy ones take up a lot of space and they usually seem boring for children in a little while. Electronic toys that you have to assemble on your own could be too complicated for certain ages of children and if a wire is accidentally disconnected, they whole toy won't work.

When I was a child, I preferred electronic toys. They were usually a lot of fun, especially if I could assemble them myself.

That's all for now. Call me back and tell me whether we should use the pictures. Bye!

Suggested answer for Writing an email. Task 1:

My parents give me some pocket money once a week. I usually spend it on hanging out with my friends. We go to cafes or chill out at home. I think I can manage my money because sometimes I put money aside if I want to buy something expensive.

By the way, it's great news that you've spent the whole weekend shopping in a shopping centre near your house. How many floors are there in the centre? What kind of shops are there? Is it very crowded?

Writing an email. Task 2

You have received an email message from your English-speaking pen-friend Jane:

From: Jane@mail.uk
To: Russian_friend@ege.ru
Subject: Shopping
... I'm going shopping with my friends this evening. I've got lots of coupons for different shops from my birthday. Do you prefer to shop online or in brick-and-mortar shops? Why do you think so many people like to spend their weekends in big shopping malls? Do you like to go shopping on your own or with friends or parents and why? By the way, I celebrated my birthday last week ...

Write an email to Jane.

In your message:

- answer her questions;
- ask **3 questions** about her birthday.

Write **100–140 words**.

Remember the rules of email writing.

Writing Task 38. Analysing and describing data

The data for the essay tasks that you will have to describe and compare is always presented in the form of a table or a pie chart. The best way to choose the tasks is to look at the problem sections and decide which task is easier to address. Once you have chosen which task to do, you have to make a short plan.

You should think of:

- A thesis statement (first sentence that expresses a general idea of the essay topic).
- Which data to write about in which paragraph (2nd or 3rd).
- What problem you are going to write about and what the solution to this problem is.
- The section with your own ideas (point 5 of the plan) is not very difficult. You may choose not to bother yourself with that when you plan what to write.

Put the following steps of approaching the data in the correct order.

- Think of different ways of putting data into words.
- Think of how you will talk about other figures that are left.
- Look at the data and choose which figures you will compare.
- Write paragraphs two and three.
- Figure out what the correlation of the figures is and what comment you will give.

Now look at the following table and the task. Which data are you going to compare and which data will you describe? What will you write as a comment?

Imagine that you are doing a project on **what modern teenagers spend pocket money on in Zetland**. You have found some data on the subject – the results of a survey (see the table below).

- select and report 2-3 facts;
- make 1-2 comparisons where relevant and give your comments.

The survey question: What do you spend your pocket money on?	
Goods	Number of respondents (%)
Textbooks and stationery for school	53
Cafes and restaurants	24
Clothes	15
Computer games	6
Cinema	2

Read the suggested answers. How are the expert's ideas different from yours? Are your ideas also logical?

Sample answer for Writing an email. Task 2

Dear Jane,

Thanks for your email. It's always great to get a letter from you.

In your email you asked me a few questions about the way I shop. I prefer shopping online. I don't like crowded places and shopping malls seem to be much too crowded for me. In my opinion, so many people like shopping there because they can see and touch the things they want to buy. It's easier to make a decision whether you need those things or not. I like to go shopping with my friends. They usually give me good advice. I feel embarrassed when I'm with my mom in a shop.

Wow, congratulations with your birthday! Where did you celebrate it? How many people came? What did you get as birthday presents?

Hope to hear from you soon.

All the best,
Masha

139 words

Answers for Writing Task 38. Analysing and describing data**Steps of the plan: C E B A D**

You should first understand how you will comment on the data you have decided to compare. If you do not know what to say, you should choose other data you have something to say about.

Facts and comparisons:

According to the statistics, the majority of the respondents buy textbooks and stationery for school with their pocket money (53%). Almost a quarter of those surveyed pay in cafes and restaurants themselves (24%). 15% of the youngsters spend their pocket money on clothes. Computer games and cinema tickets are only bought by a very small percentage of the respondents (6% and 2% respectively).

Interestingly, more than twice as many of the teenagers spend their pocket money on textbooks and stationery (53%) as on cafes and restaurants (24%). In addition, the lowest percentage of the respondents spend money on entertainment. It seems that teenagers in Zetland study all the time and do not have much fun.

Reporting on different facts.

How can you put the following data into words?

25% _____	10% _____
50% _____	75% _____
33% _____	20% _____

- When you lack 1 or 2 percentage points, you can use the words almost, approximately, under, just under (for 1 percentage point only).
- When you have 1 or 2 extra percentage points, you can use the words more than, over, just over (for 1 percentage point only).
- Sometimes it is not possible to put figures into words.

Now try to put these data into words:

23% _____ 9% _____
 51% _____ 21% _____
 31% _____ 17% _____

There are different ways we can name people who took part in a survey. In general, there are four types of respondents in EGE tasks: people in Zetland, young people in Zetland and teenagers in Zetland and old people in Zetland. Put the following synonyms into appropriate columns. Some of them can be used to describe two or all four groups.

the teenagers	the senior citizens	the adolescents
the youth	the youngsters	the elderly
the young people	the young adults	the respondents
the people	the old	those surveyed

Teenagers	Young people	People	Old people

Writing Task 38. Making comparisons

The last feature of data description is data comparison. While approaching the task, you first need to figure out what data you will compare and why (your comment).

You can employ different vocabulary to compare figures. Look at these examples:

Four times as many of the respondents prefer swimming (20%) as those who choose football (5%).

Approximately twice as many of the teenagers receive chocolate as a birthday present (15%) as those who are given gadgets (8%).

Half again as many of the people read books on holidays (15%) as those who spend time in the country (10%).

Now, look at the following figures. What is the correlation?

20 – 40 _____	12 – 18 _____
10 – 30 _____	12 – 24 _____
10 – 40 _____	13 – 39 _____
10 – 15 _____	15 – 22 _____

Answers for Writing Task 38. Analysing and describing data

Describing data:

25% = a quarter	10% = one tenth
50% = half	75% = three quarters
33% = a third \ one third	20% = one fifth
23% = almost a quarter	
51% = a little more than half	
31% = approximately a third	
9% = just under one tenth	
21% = over\more than one fifth	
17% = 17 percent	

Teenagers	Young people	People	Old people
the teenagers	the respondents	the people	the old
the respondents	the youth	the respondents	the elderly
the youth	the young people	those surveyed	the senior citizens
the adolescents	the young adults		the respondents
the young people	those surveyed		those surveyed
the youngsters			
those surveyed			

Have you paid attention to the articles? What have you noticed? (We need to use the definite article when referring to the respondents).

When we report on the data in the second and in the third paragraphs, we should stick to the same tenses all the time – Present Simple or Past Simple. If you use different tenses, you will lose a point in Text Organisation.

Answers for Writing Task 38. Making comparisons

20 – 40 twice as many	12 – 18 half again as many
10 – 30 three times as many	12 – 24 twice as many
10 – 40 four times as many	13 – 39 three times as many
10 – 15 half again as many	15 – 22 half again as many

Now, write at least three full sentences and compare different figures from the following tasks:

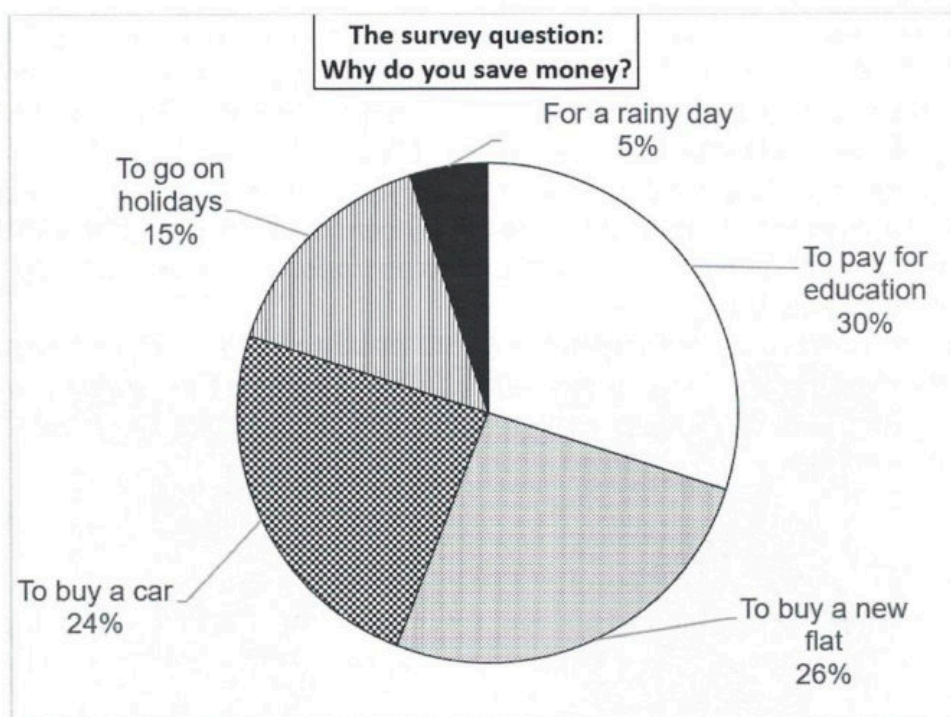
Imagine that you are doing a project on **what modern teenagers spend pocket money on in Zetland**. You have found some data on the subject – the results of a survey (see the table below).

The survey question: What do you spend your pocket money on?	
Goods	Number of respondents (%)
Textbooks and stationery for school	53
Cafes and restaurants	24
Clothes	15
Computer games	6
Cinema	2

Writing Task 38. Task 2

Imagine that you are doing a project on **why people in Zetland save money**. You have found some data on the subject – the results of a survey (see the pie chart below).

Comment on the survey data and give your opinion on the subject of the project.



Write 200-250 words.

Use the following plan:

- make an opening statement on the subject of the project;
- select and report 2-3 facts;
- make 1-2 comparisons where relevant and give your comments;
- outline a problem that one can face saving money and suggest a way of solving it;
- conclude by giving and explaining your **opinion** on the importance of saving money.

Suggested answers for Writing Task 38. Making comparisons:

More than twice as many of the teenagers spend their pocket money on textbooks and stationery (53%) as on cafes and restaurants (24%).

Buying computer games is three times more popular (6%) than going to the cinema (2%) among the adolescents.

Four times as many of the youngsters spend money in cafes and restaurants (24%) as on computer games (6%).

Sample answer for Writing Task 38. Task 1

Nowadays modern teenagers have a great variety of options to spend their pocket money on. I am currently doing a project on what modern teenagers spend their pocket money on in Zetland and have found some results of a relevant survey in the form of a table.

As can be seen in the data, 15% of the youngsters spend their pocket money on clothes. Computer games and cinema tickets are only bought by a very small percentage of the respondents (6% and 2% respectively).

Interestingly, more than twice as many of the teenagers spend their pocket money on textbooks and stationery (53%) as on cafes and restaurants (24%). In addition, the lowest percentage of the respondents spend money on entertainment. It seems that teenagers in Zetland study all the time and do not have much fun.

Unfortunately, there is a problem one can face spending money. Some people prefer to spend all their money once they get it. Then they cannot buy anything else until they get a new salary or pocket money. To tackle the problem, people should learn how to budget carefully by reading special literature.

In conclusion, I believe that teenagers spend their pocket money mostly on entertainments. They go to the cinema and theme parks, buy computer games and hang out with friends in shopping malls. It is logical because adolescence is the time people should learn how to entertain themselves.

232 words

Sample answer for Writing Task 38. Task 2:

People have different reasons for saving money. I am currently doing a project on why people in Zetland save money. I have found some results of a relevant survey in the form of a pie chart and I believe these data are useful for my project.

According to the pie chart, almost the same number of the respondents save money to buy a car and a new flat (24% and 26% respectively). The minority of those surveyed have their savings for a rainy day (5%).

Interestingly, money is saved by twice as many of the people to pay for education (30%) as to go on holidays (15%). This seems predictable as getting education is of utmost importance and it helps to get a decent job or a promotion. In this case a person has extra money to go on holidays, so there is no need to save it.

Although many people manage to save money successfully, there is a problem that can arise. When people save money at home, sometimes they have a huge sum. This money could be stolen if someone finds out that people have it in their own house or flat. To tackle the problem, it is much safer to keep extra money in a bank.

In conclusion, I think saving money is of utmost importance. It makes people think about the future. Moreover, one can spend the sum in case of a rainy day.

235 words